

amateur operators of that time and made roughly 80 per cent of the amateur operators give up their hobby. However, a large number of them continued and utilised the unregulated portion of the spectrum.

By 1917, all amateur radio operations had ceased as a result of a congressional regulation in the United States due to World War I. This regulation even demanded the dismantling of amateur radio equipment. However, amateur radio operations were allowed to continue after the war and restarted on the 1st October 1919. By the 1920s, hams were competing across the world to build more powerful transmitters and receivers. The development of single side band modulation (a modulation technique used at high frequency that provides low quality audio, albeit at exceptionally high reliability) has been attributed to hams.

By the 1930s, further regulations were placed on hams across Europe and America. However, certain bands were also protected and allotted to them. By the 1940s, hams gained a lot of attention due to their assistance with the war efforts. Father Maximilian Kolbe, a Polish ham operator, was arrested by the Nazis and imprisoned at Auschwitz, where he died a martyr saving another man's life. He was later canonised by the Catholic church and is today the patron saint of amateur radio operators.

During the world war, with almost all the amateur radio operators in the allied countries joining the armed forces, their resources were pooled to create the war emergency radio service. It remained active until 1945. With this service dismantled in 1945, the hams were in possession of a large supply of wartime radio equipment, which would later be converted for amateur use.

Throughout the 1950s, amateur radio gained popularity across the world. With the launch of the first amateur radio satellite (OSCAR) in 1961, amateur radio became practically

Hams have played a vital role in emergency situations since the days of the World War

global. Hams across the world continued to provide essential services during war and peace, disaster and rescue. Some notable contributions were during the Falklands crisis, among others.